



Automatic dial hack

Developer discovers way to automatically dial a number using your phone
<http://dgit.in/DialHack>



Sony's Selfie Camera

Sony's new selfie-centered Cybershot camera looks like a perfume bottle
<http://dgit.in/CybershotSelfie>

Work @ tech

Social media is more than just cat videos and selfies

It's important to keep a tab on all popular social media sites where there's considerable discussion about startup technologies and business-related issues. There are some really informative subreddits on Reddit, which might just be the source of the next big startup idea. Some examples are r/startups, r/DIY, r/Technology and r/Entrepreneur. r/AlphaandBetaUsers is a useful forum for testing products.

Harnessing the power and reach of social media is key to marketing and publicising an idea. Ayush Varshney, co-founder of the successful online merchandising startup Bluegape acknowledges the role played by social media in spreading word of mouth and claims that it's valuable when compared to traditional advertisement. He said, "Twitter and Facebook can actually be useful in developing a business and, at times, act as a fertile ground for ideas. Following relevant people can vastly improve your Twitter feed and can be a genuine source of information." When quizzed about the role of Twitter in staying updated with startup related news, Kushal Bhagia, founder of the innovative education startup Nayi Disha Studios mentioned that he gained plenty of knowledge from following the people in the tech startup scene on Twitter. "People actively talk about and share links to interesting stuff for budding entrepreneurs there. Say you're interested in Mobile/Android/e-Commerce...whatever – follow the founders in that space, follow VCs in that space and your feed automatically brings all the relevant news to you," he said.

What after the idea?

OK, you have an idea. What now? You implement it, execute it and test it in that order. It's always a good idea to bring out a beta product and test it. The best strategy is to have a minimal viable prototype ready to pitch. Then elicit feedback from a set of beta testers. erlibird.com is an excellent resource, but it has sufficient coverage only outside India. Plenty of young entrants in the startup scene use betalist and startupli.st for advertising their beta products. These tools are

53%

According to a study roughly 53% of Twitter users recommend products in their tweets. LinkedIn is the most popular social media site to distribute B2B content.

similar in core functionality, but differ in a few features. They're undoubtedly excellent sources to look for ideas as well as test and promote ideas. Some other options for beta product testing are Appstorm, Dribbble and Frost, the last two of which have proven to be useful for design or UX/UI based products.

If your product or idea is targeted at a specific country, then posting about that product on Facebook pages and forums might get you some beta testers, who can provide helpful feedback. Facebook forums are also a great place to market your product to a relevant crowd. Although internet penetration in India isn't very high, the number of eyeballs that Facebook and other social forums obtain is huge.

Targeting well read blogs like TechCrunch, VentureBeat or Wired will get your product noticed in the big circles. Speaking to the right people, specifically the influential kind, is critical. Also, often you must rely on giving talks and presenting demos about the benefit of your product. Although old fashioned and traditional, it has a benefit of establishing a direct connect.

65%

Here's a staggering statistic. According to a Forbes feature, a massive 65% of the jobs in the U.S. created since 1995 are in small businesses.

Team building and development

A startup needs a dedicated core team that may or may not be segregated by task. In cases when the startup is the result of an idea generated by a team, a few other members may be sought, else it's quite a task assembling a team to run a startup. Attending hackathons and job fairs can help in recruiting the right people for technical jobs such as website building. There are dedicated and motivated technical professionals willing to slog it out in startups rather than spend years in the comfort of steady jobs in multinational companies. Targeted and specific advertisements calling for job applicants can be posted on online portals such as Naukri, Monster, Internshala and twenty19.com.

Interacting with various entrepre-



A direct interaction-based product pitch

neurs from varying age groups will help you refine your idea. Attending conferences and talks will put you in touch with such enterprising folk. It's also extremely important to attend a variety of events and camps organised across the country to keep a tab on the startup scene in India. TechSparks and MobileSparks are flagship events and feature many budding entrepreneurs under a single roof. There are various big events and conferences like unplugged and BigMobility conference held every year, headlining the biggest names in the startup industry. Technical festivals in reputed engineering and management colleges usually have popular business contests that attract a large number of participants from the college crowd, a source of plenty successful startups. 